



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Modern life can be problematic sometimes!



Learning Outcome

Explain about technology and technical problems in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Are you curious about the way electronic devices work? Why or why not?
- If a device or an appliance stopped working at home, would you be able to fix it by yourself?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about technology.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can ask for clarification or use rhetorical questions to emphasize a point.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa keeps getting **poor*** Internet reception at home. What could be the problem?

* "Poor" can refer to the bad quality of a service or an electronic signal.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Rachel:** Hello, this is Rachel from InternetPlus speaking. How can I help you?
- Vanessa:** Hi ... It looks like I'm having more Internet problems.
- Rachel:** What seems to be the issue?
- Vanessa:** The Wi-Fi signal is very bad.
- Rachel:** Alright ... It sounds like you might have a problem with your router.
- Vanessa:** Do you know how I can solve this? Do you think I should take it apart?
- Rachel:** No, nothing so technical! Can you tell me where the router is located in your apartment?
- Vanessa:** Does it matter?
- Rachel:** Yes, it does. The reception is better if you put it in a central location. Always make sure that the laptop is less than 20 feet away from it.
- Vanessa:** My apartment is quite small ...
- Rachel:** You could try resetting the router. It may be a firmware issue.
- Vanessa:** Could you explain to me what that means?
- Rachel:** It's a piece of software that runs the router. You should make sure all the lights are green. If they aren't, I would switch the router off and go back to the factory preset.
- Vanessa:** Let me check. Oh no! The lights are all off.
- Rachel:** It may be a hardware issue in that case.
- Vanessa:** Great ...



Let's Practice!

Vanessa has a few questions for Rachel. Rachel asks for clarification.

Instructions: Complete the questions by choosing from the following list of words.

Word Bank

- Can you explain to me ...
- Can you tell me where ...
- Explain to me ...
- Do you think I should ...
- Do you know how ...

1. _____ I can solve this?
2. _____ take it apart?
3. _____ what that means?
4. _____ the router is located in your apartment?



Let's Practice!

Vanessa and Rachel get technical. What words do they use?

Instructions: Match the words on the left with their definitions on the right.

- | | |
|----------------|---------------------------|
| 1. reception | a. forwards Internet data |
| 2. hardware | b. take apart |
| 3. firmware | c. piece of equipment |
| 4. router | d. quality of a signal |
| 5. disassemble | e. software in a device |





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about a technical problem.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a dialogue (10 - 14 lines) about how to solve a common technical problem.
- Use the words you learned in this lesson.
- Give advice to your partner on the steps to take to solve the issue.
- Ask for clarification and for advice.
- Exchange roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about technology.

☐
☐

I discuss technical problems.

☐
☐

I give advice on how to deal with technical problems.

☐
☐

I ask for clarification on technical issues.

☐
☐


Target Words

- router** (noun): a device that forwards Internet data through a network
e.g. I don't have Wi-Fi at home. I think I may have a problem with the router.
- to take apart** (verb): to disassemble, often used for electronic devices
e.g. Should I take the router apart to see what the problem is?
- reception** (noun): the quality of receiving electromagnetic communication
e.g. The reception is better if you put your router in a central location.
- signal** (noun): an electrical impulse or electromagnetic wave you send or receive
e.g. The Wi-Fi signal is very bad.
- to reset** (verb): to set again differently
e.g. You should try resetting the router.
- firmware** (noun): a piece of software embedded in a device
e.g. If the router doesn't work, it may be a firmware issue.
- hardware** (noun): the physical elements of an electronic system
e.g. If all the lights are off, then it's a hardware problem.
- factory preset** (noun): the particular way an electronic device was set up before you used it for the first time
e.g. If the router still doesn't work, go back to the factory preset.





Learning Points

Questions Within Sentences

You ask for clarification when you want more details of what the other person is talking about.

We often ask for clarification when we are not clear on what the other person is referring to. We ask the other person to be more specific by giving more information.

You can use questions with sentences to ask for clarification. You ask a question including a sentence within the question, like *Don't you think it sounds a bit too intense?*

Questions with sentences are called **embedded questions**.

You can use **embedded questions**, like *Can you tell me ... ?* or *Do you know if/which/what ... ?* to ask for clarification.

Look at the chart below for an explanation on how to make embedded questions.

Main Question	Embedded Question
Do you know ...	what/where/when/who/ ... ?
Do you remember ...	what/where/when/who/ ... ?
Can you tell me ...	what/where/when/who/ ... ?
Could you tell me ...	what/where/when/who/ ... ?

Examples:

- *Do you know how I can solve this technical problem? (question with sentence)*
- *Can you tell me where the router is located in your apartment? (asking for clarification)*





Learning Points

Discussing How to Deal With Problems

One way to discuss how to deal with problems is to say what you would do if you were in someone else's situation. It is particularly useful if you want to discuss a complicated technical problem.

If you write an article about solving issues, you can use modals like *would*, *should* or *could* to suggest solutions and offer assistance.

I would ...

I wouldn't ...

You could ...

You can also use *must*, *might want to* or Imperatives to strongly suggest a solution.

You might want to ...

You must ...

Always check ...

These are examples of a technical assistant giving suggestions about how to deal with technical problems.

Examples:

- *It sounds like you might have a problem with your router.*
- *You could try resetting the router.*
- *You should make sure all the lights are green.*
- *If they aren't, I would switch the router off and go back to the original factory preset.*
- *Always make sure that your laptop is less than 20 feet away from the router.*

